

Abundance Federation

Pilot 01: Micro-Pilot

Building the a scalable process

Kickoff Call • April 2026

Progress Since February

We have moved significantly since February. Here's what's already in motion:

Volunteer Platform

- 4 developers actively building
- In discussions with Alone
- Meeting with Irish Red Cross as potential early adopters

Datasets & AI

- Tonight: - the micro-pilot team
- Academic oversight from TCD and UCD
- School outreach underway for scaled pilots in September. Transition Year coordinators reviewing our dataset project proposal.

Foundations

- Legal setup underway (as a first step we are creating a company limited by guarantee)
- Branding & marketing strategy in development
- Recruitment strategy being refined

Why The DataSet Project Matters

The Problem

AI datasets are the raw material of modern technology.

Right now, they're almost entirely built by private companies, for private benefit.

The public has no stake in the data that trains the systems shaping their lives.

Our Response

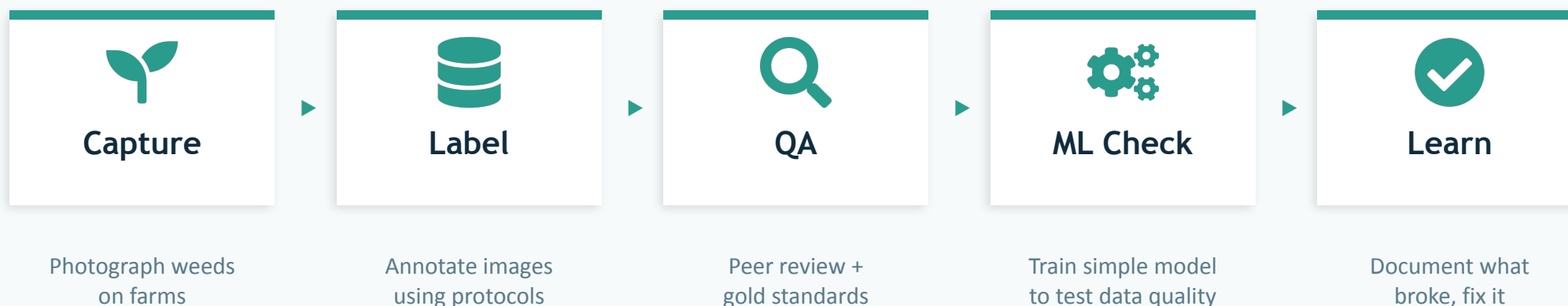
We're proving that communities can build high-quality AI datasets for public benefit.

Starting with agriculture in Ireland.
Overseen by researchers at Trinity College Dublin and UCD.

If this works, it scales to thousands of contributors and dozens of domains (energy, housing, health, logistics etc.)

What Is the Micro-Pilot?

A small team runs the full dataset creation cycle on a tiny dataset. We fix what breaks, repeat 2–3 times, then scale. We are already lining up schools for a September roll out but we need to prove the process first.



🔄 **Repeat 2–3 times, then scale to larger groups**

The Concrete Task

1

Farm

Irish vegetable farm

3-4

Data Scientists

Build the system

3-4

Non-Experts

Test our protocols

~500

Images

Labelled & QA'd

12

Weeks

April – June 2026

Domain: Irish weed identification for precision agriculture

Goal: Prove that structured volunteer processes can produce data a scientist would trust

Who's Involved

Us — The Micro-Pilot Team

We design, build, test, and document the full process.

Non-Expert Test Volunteers

3–4 people with no data science background. They test our protocols and training materials—their mistakes show us what to fix before we scale to larger groups.

Domain Experts

Agricultural scientists who define what weeds to target, how to identify them, and what “good data” looks like.

Academic Oversight

Professor Simon Wilson (Trinity College Dublin) and Professor Andrew Hines (UCD). They review our methodology and validate the quality of our outputs.

Four Areas of Focus



Data Collection

KoboToolbox setup, capture protocols, export & ingestion pipeline



Annotation Platform

Label Studio deployment, taxonomy config, volunteer workflow



Quality Assurance

Gold-standard tracking, inter-annotator agreement, calibration



Analysis & ML

Dataset overview, quality metrics, baseline model, error analysis



This Week: Review Three Documents

Pilot 01 Outline

~20 min

What we're building, the definition of success, the operational flow. Read this first.

Tooling & Infrastructure Plan

~25 min

How we'll implement it technically. Think about which functional area interests you.

Crowdsourcing Weed Data

~15 min

Background research on data quality and bias. Good context for protocol design.

Before next week: have a think about which part of the work interests you most.

The Next Four Weeks

Week 1

Tonight — Orientation

Introductions • The why & what • Document Reviews

Rick to set up GitHub & Google Drive this week

Week 2 + 3

Next Tuesday — Roles & First Tasks

Discuss documents • Agree on roles • Assign first tasks

Team starts building

Week 4

Academic Advisor Joins

Academic perspective • Progress review • Domain expert update

Any developing questions or blockers can be addressed with expert insight.

After Week 4: weekly 30-minute syncs + async efforts. The build phase begins.

Questions?